# FA26 Data Analytics Capstone: Product R&D Strategy

*Last updated: October 2026 | Created by: COOP Careers*

> This project is a fictional learning exercise. It uses public information about a real company, but it does not represent work done for, requested by or endorsed by Ivy Health AI, String Health Inc., Bellabeat or any other company named in this brief.

## 1. Welcome

**What this brief is.** This brief is your guide to the FA26 Data Analytics capstone. It explains the industry, the client, the question, how you will decide, what you will produce and how you will be evaluated. Keep it open on every capstone night.

**What the capstone asks you to do.** For this capstone, your cohort works as one data consultancy. Your client is Ivy Health AI (Ivy), a women's health technology company. Ivy must decide where to spend its research and development (R&D) next quarter. R&D is the money and staff time a company spends creating or improving products before they earn revenue. Ivy has four product lines that could receive R&D, and it can fund only two. Your cohort will study all four, compare them with evidence and recommend which two Ivy should fund.

The capstone runs over one Capstone Introduction Night and six working nights, called Capstone Nights 1 to 6. A few names appear often in this brief. Here is a one-line preview of each before you meet them in full:

- **AI Disclosure Statement:** a shared document, one per pod, that records how the pod uses and checks AI.
- **Engagement Review Committee:** the group inside your own firm that reviews a recommendation before it goes to the client.
- **Internal R&D Proposal:** the cohort's one slide deck, presented to the Engagement Review Committee on Night 6.
- **Product Investment Memo:** the cohort's one written recommendation, addressed to the client.
- **Running agenda:** one shared document for the whole cohort where each pod records its progress before every night.
- **Peer review:** the honest conversation, inside each pod, about how each fellow contributed.

**What this project tests.**

- **A data-driven recommendation with a clear framework.** Each pod scores one product line on Desirability, Feasibility, Viability and Strategic fit, with evidence and a source for every score. The cohort turns four scorecards into one recommendation.
- **Responsible, disclosed AI use.** Fellows check what AI produces and log every use in the pod's AI Disclosure Statement.

- **Professional communications.** The Internal R&D Proposal is a deck for the firm's own internal Engagement Review Committee; the Product Investment Memo is what the client receives.
- **Industry exposure.** How consumer health technology makes money, what women need from health products, and how to work when the client will not share its data.
- **Collaborating in groups.** Owning work, loading the running agenda, presenting on Night 6 and honest peer review.

## 2. The industry in plain terms

**What the industry does.** Ivy works in consumer health technology. This industry makes products that people buy for themselves to understand or improve their health: smartphone apps, wearables, at-home tests and the online services that connect them. A wearable is a device worn on the body, such as a ring, bracelet or watch, that collects health data. A doctor does not prescribe these products and an insurer does not pay for them. The company must persuade each person to buy the product and then to keep using it.

Ivy's part of the industry is femtech, short for female technology. Femtech covers products built for women's health: menstrual cycles, fertility, pregnancy, perimenopause and menopause. Perimenopause is the years of hormonal change before a woman's final period. Grand View Research, a market research firm, estimates the femtech market at about $52.9 billion for 2026 in its 2026 edition. In plain terms, women's health technology is a large market, and any market size is one firm's estimate, so always cite one edition and its year.

**How money is made.** Companies like Ivy earn money in three main ways.

- **Hardware.** The company sells a device once.
- **Subscriptions.** Customers pay a recurring monthly or yearly fee for premium features or content. A subscription is often called a membership.
- **Repeat purchases.** Customers buy consumable products more than once, such as tests or supplements.

**Where the industry is moving.** AI health assistants, which answer health questions in a chat, have become a main area of competition, and companies are moving toward answers based on each user's own data.

## 3. The client

**Who they are.** Ivy Health AI is the consumer brand of String Health Inc. The company began as Bellabeat, a women's health technology company founded by Urška Sršen and Sandro Mur. Bellabeat has had offices in San Francisco and Zagreb, Croatia. It became known for wellness trackers designed to look like jewelry rather than sports equipment.

**From Bellabeat to Ivy.**

| Year | What happened |
|---|---|
| 2014 | Bellabeat went through Y Combinator, the startup accelerator |

| Year | What happened |
|---|---|
| 2015 | Launched Leaf, a wellness tracker worn as jewelry |
| 2016 | Launched Spring, a smart water bottle |
| 2017 | Launched Airi, a chat-based wellness coach offered as a subscription feature |
| 2018 | Launched Period Diary, a cycle-tracking app |
| 2019 | Launched Bellabeat+, a paid membership |
| 2021 | Launched Ivy, a tracker worn on the wrist, which received over 50,000 preorders |
| 2022 | Began seeking FDA approval for Ivy's cycle tracking; Lider Media reported that certification could take up to five years |
| April 2025 | Joined a new group called STRING, with three parts: Ivy Technologies (women's health products), StringAI (health AI infrastructure) and String Capital (investments) |

Today, bellabeat.com says the company is "becoming Ivy AI". It describes an AI-first women's health platform built around women's biology. The platform combines biometric data, cycle intelligence, behavioral patterns and AI models. Biometric data means measurements taken from the body, such as heart rate and temperature. The site says this platform "is being built". The footer of ivyhealth.ai names String Health Inc. as the company behind the site.

In plain terms, a company that spent about ten years selling attractive trackers and wellness apps now says it is becoming an AI company for women's health.

**What Ivy sells.** Ivy sells products in four lines. A product line is a group of related products. These four lines are the four options in this capstone, and each pod studies one of them.

- **IVY+ Wearable.** The only hardware Ivy sells. A bracelet that, according to its product page, measures heart rate, resting heart rate, respiratory rate, temperature patterns, sleep, stress and readiness. Preview: the question is what the next version of the bracelet should add, improve or remove.
- **IVY Apps and AI Health Assistant.** Two separate apps. IVY Wellness Coach supports the device and the membership. IVY Period and Pregnancy Tracker is the cycle-tracking app, and the AI Health Assistant sits inside it. Preview: the question is where users get value from the two apps and what the assistant should do next.
- **Premium Membership.** A paid plan offered inside the IVY Wellness Coach app, built around content and coaching. Preview: the question is what would make people pay for a membership and keep paying.
- **At-Home Testing and Supplements.** At-home blood tests for women's hormones, fertility and menopause, and a small range of supplements. Preview: the question is whether Ivy should invest R&D in these products or keep selling them as they are.

Leaf, Time and the Spring water bottle are legacy products. A legacy product is no longer sold but is still supported for existing owners. Legacy products are never options in this capstone.

## 4. The client's situation

**What changed.** In April 2025 Ivy joined the STRING group, beside a sister business focused on health AI. Ivy now says it is becoming an AI-first women's health platform, and it says that platform is still being built. Its four product lines were launched at different times over about ten years, under the Bellabeat name and then the Ivy name.

**Why Ivy needs help now.** Ivy must set its R&D priorities for next quarter. At a consumer health technology company, R&D is mostly product and engineering work. It includes writing app software, building and training AI models, and updating firmware, the software that runs inside a device. When a feature makes a health claim, R&D also includes gathering the evidence a regulator expects. Every engineer or data scientist assigned to one product line is unavailable to another. Ivy cannot fund all four lines at once, so it has asked your firm which two to fund.

**The tension between the options.** Each line makes a different case for the money.

- The lines earn money in different ways: a one-time device purchase, a recurring membership or repeat purchases of tests and supplements.
- Some work could be delivered quickly with parts Ivy already has, while other work would take longer or need new evidence.
- Some lines may have strong demand from users but carry rules or risks that limit what Ivy can build in 2027.
- Some lines may sit closer to the AI-first direction Ivy has chosen than others.

Your job is to weigh these with evidence, not to assume which matters most before you look.

## 5. Your role and firm

**Your firm.** Your cohort is one data consultancy. The firm is never named. A data consultancy helps a client make a decision based on evidence. Its staff define the question, find and clean the data, analyze it, explain what it does and does not show, and recommend a course of action.

**Your role.** You are an Associate at the firm, with the title **Data Analytics Consultant**. Each pod has three to five Associates.

**Your client contact.** Ivy's head of product is your client contact. This is the executive who decides which product initiatives receive R&D. The head of product does not attend any capstone night. Ivy receives your recommendation as one written memo, the Product Investment Memo.

**Your captain.** Your cohort has multiple Captains who act as the pod's Junior Managers and mentors the whole cohort. Your captain does not write your work or give you the answer, but they will help you navigate the work by managing logistics such as permissions and leading meetings.

**The Senior Manager and the internal committee.** The Senior Manager is the senior captain for your cohort. The Senior Manager alone sits as the firm's **Engagement Review Committee**. In a consultancy, an engagement review committee tests a recommendation before it is sent to a client. On Night 6 the Senior Manager hears your cohort's presentation, decides on the recommendation and evaluates it.

## 6. The question

Every capstone has one forcing question. A forcing question makes you choose: it cannot be answered with "all of them" or "it depends".

> **If Ivy can fund only two of four product R&D initiatives next quarter, which two should it fund, and why those two over the other two?** - IVY+ Wearable - IVY Apps and AI Health Assistant - Premium Membership - At-Home Testing and Supplements

An initiative is one funded piece of R&D work on one product line, with a start date and measurable results.

**The 2027 horizon.** Your answer covers 2027. The two funded initiatives begin in Q1 2027, meaning January to March 2027. Each of the other two product lines receives a position and a revisit condition. A revisit condition is the specific evidence or event that would lead Ivy to reconsider that line later in 2027. A position without a revisit condition is incomplete, because Ivy needs to know what would change the decision.

**The objective and key results.** An objective and key results (OKR) is a goal format with one objective and two to four measurable key results. A key result is a measurable sign of progress toward the objective.

- **Objective:** Grow the number of engaged, paying users by focusing R&D on what makes Ivy different in women's health. An engaged, paying user is a person who uses Ivy's products regularly and pays Ivy for at least one of them.
- **Key results:** your cohort proposes two to four, each with a baseline and a target. A baseline is the starting value. Example key results, written in general form: raise a named app's store rating from its baseline; increase the device connection rate; improve the 30-day retention of new users; increase the share of free users who become paying members.
- **Rule for baselines:** where a baseline is public, such as a store rating, record it with the store and the date you checked it. Where no public number exists, state that the baseline will be set in Q1 2027.

**Budget.** Ivy has not set an R&D budget. Your cohort decides what each funded initiative needs and explains why.

## 7. The positions you can take

Every pod finishes with one position for its product line, using one of these exact words.

| Position | What it means | Counts as one of the two choices? |
|---|---|---|
| Build | Ivy funds a new capability, one that does not yet exist, starting in Q1 2027 | Yes |
| Improve | Ivy funds upgrades to a product or capability that already exists, starting in Q1 2027 | Yes |
| Deprioritize | Ivy invests no new R&D next quarter and keeps the product running as it is; the pod names the revisit condition | No |

| Position | What it means | Counts as one of the two choices? |
|---|---|---|
| Reposition | Ivy changes the role the product plays, with little or no R&D next quarter; the pod states the new role and the revisit condition | No, unless the change needs R&D money, which the pod must say |

The cohort's recommendation names two of the four product lines as its two choices. Each choice stands on its own scorecard. A pod that recommends Deprioritize or Reposition for its own line, with a strong scorecard, can earn full marks.

### 8. Your pod

There are four pods, one per product line. No single pod can answer the forcing question alone. The cohort agrees its answer on Night 5 after hearing all four positions.

| Pod | Option | Pod question |
|---|---|---|
| Pod 1 | IVY+ Wearable | Based on how people use wearable health data, especially for cycle and perimenopause needs, what should the next version of IVY+ add, improve or remove? |
| Pod 2 | IVY Apps and AI Health Assistant | Where do users get the most and least value from Ivy's two apps, and what should the AI Health Assistant do next to increase daily use and retention? |
| Pod 3 | Premium Membership | What would make users pay for a membership and keep it: new content, or a change in what it offers? |
| Pod 4 | At-Home Testing and Supplements | Should Ivy invest R&D in its tests and supplements (for example, connecting results to the app and AI), or keep selling them as they are? |

### 9. How you will decide: the framework

**What it is.** Product and innovation teams use three tests before they fund an idea.

- **Desirability** asks whether people want it.
- **Feasibility** asks whether the company can build it in time with what it has.
- **Viability** asks whether it will pay off for the business.

**Why the industry uses it.** An idea that fails any one of the three tests wastes R&D money.

This engagement adds a fourth criterion, **Strategic fit**. It asks whether an initiative moves Ivy toward the AI-first women's health company it says it is becoming. An initiative can pass the first three tests and still move Ivy away from that direction.

Each criterion is scored from 1 to 4. All four carry equal weight. The total is out of 16. On Night 1, in the step "Decide how you'll rank the product lines", your pod agrees how the scoring descriptions apply to its own line and records that agreement. Those descriptions do not change after Night 1.

| Criterion | What it asks | What to look at | Where to find it |
|---|---|---|---|
| Desirability | Do users want this, and does its absence hold them back? | What users praise and complain about; what they keep doing and stop doing; what women say they need that current products do not give them | App store reviews; open datasets; surveys from health and technology research organizations (KFF, Pew Research Center, Rock Health); online forums such as Reddit; your pod's own short survey |
| Feasibility | Can Ivy deliver this in 2027 with the parts it already has? | Whether it exists in some form; whether it is mainly software or needs new hardware; whether it would make a medical claim; whether it depends on another line being finished first | Ivy's product pages and support site; the FDA De Novo record for Natural Cycles; FemTech Insider and Lider Media (2022); databases of published studies (PubMed, Google Scholar) |
| Viability | Will this grow engaged, paying users, or might it lose money or users? | What people pay for and how (once, recurring or repeat); where each product is sold; whether competitors earn money from a similar offer | Ivy's shop and in-app prices, each dated; Flo, Oura and Calm offers; an app industry data publisher (Business of Apps); market reports |
| Strategic fit | Does this move Ivy toward becoming an AI-first women's health company built on its own data? | Whether it creates or uses Ivy's own data about women's bodies; whether it connects to Ivy's AI; whether it puts money into work competitors already do at larger scale | bellabeat.com; ivyhealth.ai; the AI Health Assistant page; Dnevnik.hr (April 28, 2025) |

## 10. The rubric

The rubric gives a written description, called an anchor, for each score on each criterion. Use these anchors for every score on your scorecard.

| Score | Desirability | Feasibility | Viability | Strategic fit |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Little sign users want it | Needs new capabilities or regulatory approval, so after 2027 | Likely to lose money or users | Pulls away from the AI-first direction |
| 2 | Some users want it | Possible late 2027, or only after another line is finished | Unclear return | Unrelated to the AI-first direction |
| 3 | Many users, or one key group, want it | Possible by the end of 2027 | Clear path to engagement or revenue | Supports the AI-first direction indirectly |
| 4 | Most users want it, and its absence holds them back | Possible in the first half of 2027 with existing parts | Strong path to engaged, paying users | Directly builds AI for women on Ivy's own data |

**How to read the total.**

- **13 to 16:** a strong candidate for funding.
- **10 to 12:** a possible candidate, depending on how the other lines score.
- **9 or lower:** usually Deprioritize or Reposition.

These bands are guides, not rules. The cohort chooses its two choices from the totals. When two lines tie, the cohort breaks the tie with one named criterion score, chosen in advance and stated in the memo. The total is never the whole argument. A well-argued 9 with a clear new role and revisit condition is stronger work than a weakly evidenced 15.

**How to write each score.** Every score on every scorecard is written in the same four parts:

1. **The number,** from 1 to 4.
2. **One sentence of evidence** that explains the number.
3. **The source,** with its date or the date you checked it.
4. **The research stage** the evidence came from. Your research has four stages, Explore, Find the gaps, Research and Synthesize, which tell you what to do in what order.

Use this pattern: "[Criterion] [number]. [One sentence of evidence.] Source: [source, date]. Stage: [stage]."

In plain terms, a pod cannot win an argument by being confident. It wins by showing a number, the reason for the number and where the evidence came from. The scorecard is the core of your analysis.

### 11. How you will research

**The research mandate.** Every pod follows the same four stages.

1. **Explore.** Look at what open data and Ivy's own pages can show about your product line. Open datasets are a place to start, and you may go beyond them.
2. **Find the gaps.** Write down what the data cannot answer. Turn each gap into a research question.
3. **Research.** Answer each research question with any source, quantitative or qualitative.
4. **Synthesize.** Bring the evidence together into a scorecard and a position.

No dataset is mandatory. Choose the sources that best answer your pod question.

**Source rules.**

- **All sources are equal,** and each is labeled quantitative or qualitative.
- **Quantitative** means data you can count, measure or calculate. It answers how much, how many or how often. Survey percentages, usage counts and ratings are quantitative.
- **Qualitative** means data you read and interpret. It answers why, how or what people think. Review text, forum discussions and short survey answers are qualitative.

- **Use both.** Answer each research question with at least one quantitative source and at least one qualitative source.
- **Every number carries its date or period.**
- **Every source is defended in one sentence pair:** "We leaned on [source] because [why it is credible and relevant]. Its limit is [what it cannot tell us]."

**Proxy data and the proxy statement.** Proxy data is data from similar people or products, used because the client's own data is not available. Because Ivy shares no user data, much of your evidence will be proxy data. Every finding from proxy data gets a three-line proxy statement:

1. What the source is.
2. Why it stands in for Ivy's data.
3. Where it stops being reliable.

A finding without the third line is incomplete.

**Data observation format.** Every observation you record uses four parts.

- **Where we looked:** the dataset and file, the report and page, or the store listing and date.
- **What we noticed:** one or two sentences, with numbers and their dates.
- **Why it matters for our product line:** one sentence that connects it to your option.
- **How much we trust it:** strong or weak, and the limit.

**Date ranges, and why.**

| Source type | Date range to use | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Store ratings and prices | As of the date you checked | They change often; a dated figure stays correct even after it changes |
| App reviews | The 25 most recent per app from the last 12 months | Recent reviews describe the product as it is now; a fixed number per app makes apps comparable |
| Google Trends, a free tool that shows search interest over time | Past five years, United States | Five years shows a trend rather than a single spike; one country keeps the comparison clean |
| Surveys and market reports | The latest edition, cited with its year | Editions differ; mixing them produces numbers that do not belong together |
| Open datasets | Any year, stated in the proxy statement | Older data can still show how people behave, as long as its age is named as a limit |

**Live values.** Ratings, numbers of ratings, prices, app update dates and Google Trends values change. This brief does not state them. Look them up yourself and record each one with the store or site and the date you checked it.

**Working with reviews, surveys and forums.**

- **Reviews:** take the 25 most recent reviews per app from the last 12 months. Tag each review with exactly one theme from a short list your pod agrees. Theme tagging means labeling each review with one main topic so topics can be counted.
- **Short survey:** ask five to ten people in your network about habits and preferences only, never personal health details. Report counts, such as "6 of 8 said", not percentages.
- **Forums:** quote short phrases only, never usernames. Forum posters are not a representative sample.
- **Google Trends:** values are an index from 0 to 100 that shows relative search interest over time. They are not counts of searches.
- **Older case studies:** the Google Data Analytics Certificate includes a case study about Bellabeat. Do not use its conclusions. It addressed a different question for older products.

**Spreadsheets.** You do not need a spreadsheet, and none is provided. If it helps, you can build a simple one to lay out your figures side by side.

**Resources.**

| Resource | What it is for | How to read it |
|---|---|---|
| Open data sites: Kaggle, Google Dataset Search, data.gov, CDC open data, Our World in Data, Pew Research Center datasets, Zenodo | Explore: what open data can show about your line | Note what each dataset records, who is in it, when it was collected and what it does not record |
| Optional example: Fitbit Fitness Tracker Data on Kaggle (original at Zenodo) | How about 30 people used a wrist tracker over a month in 2016 | Look at which files and data types it holds; write a proxy statement for any finding |
| Rock Health 2025 Consumer Adoption Survey | Who owns wearables and smart rings | U.S. adults, not Ivy's users |
| Pew Research Center, smartwatch and fitness tracker use (2020) | Tracker use by gender | The data is from 2020 |
| KFF, women's online health information (September 2026) | Women's use of and trust in AI chatbots for health information | Read use and trust side by side; women in general, not Ivy's users |
| Grand View Research, femtech market | Market size and growth | Cite one figure, its edition and its year |
| Google Trends | Search interest over time | An index from 0 to 100, not counts; interest is not purchase |
| Business of Apps | Revenue and subscriber trends for apps | A publisher's estimates, not company filings |
| IVY Wellness Coach (App Store, Google Play); IVY Period and Pregnancy Tracker (App Store, Google Play) | Ratings, numbers of ratings, update dates, in-app prices and reviews | Record the store and date for every figure; one theme per review |

| Resource | What it is for | How to read it |
|---|---|---|
| Competitors: Flo, Oura, Calm | Scale, ratings and membership offers | Record what each membership includes, with dates |
| Ivy: home, shop, IVY+, AI Health Assistant, journal, support, bellabeat.com | What Ivy sells, charges and claims | Marketing shows intentions, not how people use the products; date every price |
| PubMed, Google Scholar | What research says body signals can show | Read the abstract: who was studied, how many and what was found |
| Reddit: r/xxfitness, r/fitbit, r/AppleWatch, r/ouraring, r/menopause, r/Perimenopause | Needs and complaints in people's own words | Short phrases, no usernames; not representative |
| Your pod's short survey of five to ten people | Habits and preferences | Report counts; never ask about health details |
| FTC order against Flo Health (2021) | The privacy standard for women's health apps | One case about one company |
| FDA De Novo record for Natural Cycles (DEN170052) | The standard for software that makes medical claims from body data | It concerns contraception; use it to illustrate the standard |
| Statista, IBISWorld, McKinsey, "The dawn of the FemTech revolution" | Market trends | Use free summaries first; note the publisher and date |

## 12. What you will produce

Your cohort produces four kinds of deliverables and keeps two shared working documents. Two deliverables are internal working documents, required but not graded. Two are graded and carry the cohort's recommendation.

**Preliminary Discovery (one per pod, internal, required, not graded).** An internal working document of about two pages that records what your pod found about its product line and sets up its first scorecard. It is the evidence base for your pod's part of the deck and the memo. It contains:

1. A header: title, pod, date and the date range of the data used.
2. A purpose paragraph.
3. Where Ivy stands today for your line: what Ivy sells in it, its price (dated), the rating and number of ratings where an app is involved (store and date), what Ivy claims about it, and what it connects to.
4. Your scoring approach: how your pod applies the anchors to its line.
5. Three to five data observations in the four-part format.
6. A sources table: source; quantitative or qualitative; why you relied on it; its limit.
7. A first-pass scorecard, marked "Draft".
8. Three to five questions you will answer next.

It is due at the end of Night 2.

**AI Disclosure Statement (one per pod, internal, required, not graded).** Your pod's professional record of how AI was used and checked. Each pod makes its own copy of the shared template, FA26 Capstone AI Disclosure Statement (make a copy). It has five parts:

- **Part 1, Project details and ownership:** the project and who owns which piece of work.
- **Part 2, AI ideation:** ways you might use AI, each ranked from 0 to 10.
- **Part 3, AI toolkit:** the tools you will use.
- **Part 4, Agreements:** your pod's five agreements on quality, accountability and ethics.
- **Part 5, Ongoing use case log:** every use of AI, logged by the fellow who used it (date, user, tool, use case).

Parts 1 to 4 are due by the end of Night 1. Part 5 is updated every night. The statement is complete by Night 5.

**Internal R&D Proposal (one per cohort, internal, graded).** One slide deck for the whole cohort, presented on Night 6 to the Engagement Review Committee. It is an internal proposal, not a client presentation. It contains:

1. Title.
2. The recommendation, answer first: the two choices.
3. The question and scope.
4. The framework.
5. One section per pod: its product line, Discovery highlights, its scorecard with evidence and its position.
6. The four scorecards side by side.
7. Why these two and not the other two.
8. Positions and revisit conditions for the other two.
9. Alternatives considered.
10. Data limits and risks.
11. What the cohort asks the committee to approve.
12. Appendix.

Each pod drafts its own section. The Pod leads, one fellow per pod elected to coordinate the pod's work, merge the four sections into one deck.

**Product Investment Memo (one per cohort, client-facing, graded).** One memo of two to three pages, addressed to Ivy's head of product. It is the cohort's recommendation; there is no other recommendation document. It contains:

1. To, From, Date, Re.
2. The recommendation in the first two sentences, naming the two choices.
3. Background, in one paragraph.
4. What we found: one short paragraph per product line, with evidence and sources.

5. A scorecard exhibit: the four scorecards, or one combined table with one line of evidence per score.
6. Why these two and not the other two.
7. Positions and revisit conditions for the other two.
8. Risks, what Ivy should watch and when to revisit.
9. Next steps and key results, each with a baseline and a target.
10. Sources.

Each pod drafts its own section, and the Pod leads merge them. The memo is final before Night 6 begins.

**Internal compared with client-facing.** The deck is an internal proposal presented to the firm's Engagement Review Committee. The committee tests the recommendation before it leaves the firm. The client receives the recommendation as one written memo that it can read, forward and act on. In plain terms, the deck convinces your own firm, and the memo must stand on its own for the client.

**Two shared working documents.**

- **Team Charter (one per pod).** Your pod's agreement on how it works together, from the shared template "FA26 Capstone Team Charter (make a copy)". It also holds each fellow's final review, which carries the individual 20 points of the grade. Part of that review is judged against the five COOP competencies, the professional skills COOP evaluates: Initiative and Results-Driven; Collaboration; Adaptability and Managing Change; Workload Management; Resource Management.
- **Running agenda (one per cohort, not graded).** One shared document, from the template "FA26 Capstone Running Agenda (make a copy)", with one row per pod per night. Each pod loads its row with its progress before every Daily Standup, the 15-minute status check that opens each night. It is a progress tool and is never used as evidence for peer scores.

**How files are shared.** Captains build one Google Drive Project Folder per cohort and manage who can see it. The folder has two parts:

- **Internal Resources:** the deck, the running agenda, and one subfolder per pod (Pod 1 to Pod 4) holding that pod's Preliminary Discovery, AI Disclosure Statement and Team Charter.
- **Client-Facing Resources:** the Product Investment Memo only.

Pod files are named [Pod #]_[Deliverable]_v[#] and cohort files Cohort_[Deliverable]_v[#]. Sharing and naming rules are taught on Night 3 in the FA26 Capstone Business Communications deck, a short presentation on professional communication, folders, sharing and naming, and AI use. Files made before Night 3 start as Google Docs shared with your captain and move into the Project Folder that night.

## Evaluation

Your grade has two parts: **80 points shared by the whole cohort** and **20 points that are yours alone**. Every fellow in the cohort receives the same shared score. Your individual score depends only on your own contribution.

| Part | Points | Earned through | Evaluated by |
|---|---|---|---|
| Shared cohort score | 80 | The Product Investment Memo and the Night 6 presentation | The Senior Manager |
| Individual score | 20 | Your Team Charter final review: self-score and peer score | You, your pod and your captain |
| Total | 100 | | |

### The shared 80 points

The Senior Manager evaluates the memo and the Night 6 presentation on four categories of the FA26 Applied Learning rubric. Each category is scored from 0 to 4, then multiplied by 5, so each is worth up to 20 points.

| Category | What it asks |
|---|---|
| Accuracy (memo and deck) | Is every score supported by evidence, a source and a date? Did all four pods use one method? Are proxy data and live values handled correctly? |
| Utility (memo) | Could Ivy's head of product act on the memo alone? Are the two choices in the first sentences? Do the other two have clear revisit conditions? Do key results have baselines and targets? |
| Communication (memo and deck) | Do the memo and deck tell one story from evidence to choice? Do they address alternatives and data limits? |
| Presentation (Night 6) | Is the answer given first? Is every section clear? Can speakers explain their numbers and the limits of their evidence? |

| Score | Band |
|---|---|
| 0 | Incomplete |
| 1 | Emerging |
| 2 | Developing |
| 3 | Complete |
| 4 | Proficient |

Reasoning is scored, not agreement with any single answer. A well-supported recommendation can earn full marks whichever two lines it chooses. Strong answers may also note how the two choices work together, but this is not required.

### The individual 20 points

Your individual 20 points come from your final review in Part 6 of the Team Charter, completed asynchronously after Night 6.

- **Reflection:** one finding you produced, written in STAR form.
- **Self-score from 1 to 10,** with a short explanation, judged against the five COOP competencies.
- **Peer score from 1 to 10,** agreed in a pod conversation your captain leads, also judged against the five COOP competencies.

**How the peer score works.** After Night 6, your captain leads a conversation with your pod. Everyone starts at 10. A score is lowered only with clear evidence, such as owned work left undone or absences the pod was not told about. Every fellow who contributed fairly can earn full marks. The running agenda is never used as evidence. Your captain records each score and signs off your final review.

Collaboration is a skill being tested. Owning your work, helping teammates, loading the agenda and speaking honestly in peer review all count.

### Required, not graded

The Preliminary Discovery (one per pod, due end of Night 2), the AI Disclosure Statement (one per pod, Parts 1 to 4 by end of Night 1, logged every night, complete by Night 5) and the running agenda (one per cohort) carry no points, but your graded work depends on them. A weak Discovery leads to unsupported scores and a lower Accuracy score. The AI Disclosure Statement is the professional record of how your pod checked AI. Your captain checks all three every night and signs off your pod on Night 5..

## Resources

### Key materials

- Template - DFV Framework Scorecard (one copy per DA cohort)
- Template - Capstone Deliverables Drive (make a copy per cohort)
- Template - Cohort Running Agenda (make a copy per cohort)
- Template - Pod Team Charter (make a copy per pod)
- Template - AI Disclosure Statement (make a copy per pod)
- Template - Self and Peer Review Guide (make a copy per pod)
- Sample - Internal Proposal deck (optional reference)

External links

- Client: Ivy Health AI; Ivy journal; Bellabeat; String Health; Wikipedia, "Bellabeat"; Dnevnik.hr, April 28, 2025; Lider Media, February 2022; FemTech Insider, February 2022
- Industry and market: Grand View Research, femtech market; Rock Health 2025 Consumer Adoption Survey; Pew Research Center (2020); KFF (September 2026); Business of Apps
- Regulation: FTC order against Flo Health (2021); FDA De Novo record for Natural Cycles (DEN170052)
- Data: Fitbit Fitness Tracker Data on Kaggle; Fitbit data, Zenodo original; every resource linked in the resources table
- COOP: FA26 Capstone AI Disclosure Statement (make a copy); FA26 Capstone Team Charter (make a copy); FA26 Capstone Running Agenda (make a copy); FA26 Capstone Business Communications deck; FA26 Applied Learning rubric

### Words to know

| Term | Plain definition |
|---|---|
| Research and development (R&D) | Money and staff time spent creating or improving products before they earn revenue |
| Product line | A group of related products; Ivy has four that can receive R&D |
| Legacy product | A product no longer sold but still supported, such as Leaf, Time and Spring |
| Femtech | Technology built for women's health |
| Perimenopause | The years of hormonal change before a woman's final period |
| Wearable | A device worn on the body that collects health data |
| Biometric data | Measurements taken from the body, such as heart rate and temperature |

| Term | Plain definition |
|---|---|
| Firmware | The software that runs inside a device |
| Passive and active data | Data collected automatically, and data entered by hand |
| Engagement | How often people use a product |
| Retention | The share of users still active a set number of days after they start |
| Conversion | The share of free users who become paying members |
| Device connection rate | The share of app users who have connected a device |
| Initiative | One funded piece of R&D work on one product line |
| Revisit condition | The evidence or event that would lead Ivy to reconsider a line it did not fund |
| Objective and key results (OKR) | One objective with two to four measurable key results |
| Baseline | The starting value for a key result |
| Proxy data | Data from similar people or products, used when the client's data is unavailable |
| Proxy statement | Three lines for every proxy finding: what the source is, why it stands in, where it stops being reliable |
| Theme tagging | Labeling each review with one main topic so topics can be counted |
| Google Trends index | Relative search interest from 0 to 100, not a count of searches |
| Medical claim | A statement that a product diagnoses, treats or prevents a condition, which can bring FDA regulation |
| De Novo authorization | The FDA pathway for a new kind of low-to-moderate-risk device |
| Scorecard | A pod's four criterion scores, each with evidence, a source and a research stage |
| Meeting minutes | A short written record of who attended, what was decided, what actions were agreed, who owns each and when each is due |